of human rights. For me, too, it is a priority issue. We seem to have agreed that these problems require an in-depth consideration and a clear understanding of the true situation in both the United States and the Soviet Union. Traffic along this two-way street has begun and I hope that it will be intense.

Our relationship is a dynamic stream and you and I are working together to widen it. A stream cannot be slowed down, it can only be blocked or diverted. But that would not be in our interests. Politics, of course, is the art of the possible. But it is only by working and maintaining a dynamic dialogue that we will put into effect what we have made possible, and will make possible tomorrow what is yet impossible today.

Sincerely,
Mikhail Gorbachev
September 20, 1988

A year later, Gorbachev announced that the Krasnoyarsk radar station would be dismantled. A month after that, Foreign Minister Shevardnadze, in a public apology, said the facility, an earth station “equal in size to the Egyptian pyramids,” represented, “to put it bluntly, a violation of the ABM treaty,” and in the same speech, he apologized for the Soviet invasion of Afghanistan.

That fall, I went back on the campaign trail—this time, stumping the nation for George Bush and Dan Quayle. I wanted to do all I could to see that the policies we’d set in motion in 1981 would continue. During the primaries, I’d had to follow the Eleventh Commandment and remain neutral. But once George won the nomination, I did all I could to help him get elected. I knew George would be a great president.